Revision Date:
April 1, 2023

Background:
The California Work Opportunity and Responsibility to Kids (CalWORKs) Child Care Program is for current and former CalWORKs cash aid recipients to assist with paying for childcare with a provider of their choice, if they are employed or participating in approved activities.

The CalWORKs Child Care Program is provided in a single three-stage system.
Effective July 1, 2021, all three stages of the CalWORKs Child Care program are supervised by the California Department of Social Services (CDSS) Child Care and Development Division.

- **Stage One** is provided through the County of San Diego's CalWORKs Employment Services (ES) program and is designed to help customers quickly access child care when they begin working or participating in ES or Cal-Learn activities
- **Stage Two** and **Stage Three** are provided through CDSS contracts with Alternative Payment Programs (APP) and are designed to provide families long-term, stable child care to continue working once their cash aid ends

Purpose:
This revision removes reference to the previous version of Processing Guide (PG) 10-010.A4 Form 27-128 which is now obsolete and renames PG 10-010.A5 Transitioning Child Care Cases to Stage Two, to PG 10-010.A4 Transitioning Child Care Cases to Stage Two.

Policy:
CalWORKs Child Care may begin when a family starts receiving CalWORKs cash aid. Stage One Child Care is available to:

- CalWORKs recipients who are in an ES activity, or working
- Cal-Learn Pregnant or Parenting Teens who are in a high school program as well as when working in addition to the high school program
- CalWORKs sanctioned individuals who need child care to cure an ES sanction
- CalWORKs families or Former CalWORKs families who cannot receive services in Stage Two because of program barriers, Stage Two funding/staffing issues, or other administrative issues
- Former CalWORKs families with unresolved program barriers, up to 24-months post-aid

Stage Two Child Care is available to:

- CalWORKs recipients in an ES activity or working, who meet the County definition of "stable"
- Sanctioned or exempt individuals who are not in ES but who are in approved activities, or working
- Former CalWORKs families during the first 24 months off cash aid
- Families that receive lump-sum diversion services if there is no funding available in Stage Three

Stage Three Child Care is available to:

- Former CalWORKs families who are working, whose income when they transition off cash aid, does not exceed 85% of the State Median Income (SMI) and their children are not over the eligibility age; the 24-month limit does not apply to Stage Three
- Families that receive lump-sum diversion services

Form CCP7 Informing Notice Requirement

The *CalWORKs Stage One Child Care Request and Payment Rules form (CCP7)* must be provided to all CalWORKs customers to inform them about the availability of Stage One child care. The customer may request CalWORKs child care either verbally or in writing upon entry into the CalWORKs assistance program or at any later time. The earliest date of eligibility of child care is determined based upon the earliest date of the customer's verbal or written request.

Stage One Time Limit

A customer will be served a maximum of six months in Stage One unless the family's situation is determined to be unstable, or childcare is not available in Stage Two or Three. Under these circumstances, the Stage One services may be extended for more than six months.

The County of San Diego Self-Sufficiency Services (SSS) Department contracts the administration of **Stage One** Child Care services with **Public Consulting Group (PCG)** and **Equus Workforce Services**. Equus subcontracts childcare services with **YMCA Stage One**. In the County of San Diego there are two **Stage Two agencies: Child Development Associates (CDA)** and **YMCA Stage Two.**

SSS staff monitor the transfer of cases to Stage Two to ensure an equitable distribution of cases between the two Stage Two agencies. For information about transfers, including the County's definition of stability see Processing Guide 10-010.A4 *Transitioning Child Care Cases to Stage Two*.

Stage One Child Care transfers cases to Stage Two primarily according to regional assignment:

Region	Stage One Agency	Stage Two Agency
Central	PCG 4389 Imperial Avenue San Diego, CA 92113 (619) 270-4250	CDA 5473 Kearny Villa Road, Suite 350 San Diego, CA 92123 (619) 427-4411, Ext 1700
East	PCG 151 Van Houten Avenue El Cajon, CA 92020 (619) 270-4000	YMCA Stage Two 3601 Arey Drive San Diego, CA 92154 Phone Number: (619) 474-4707
South	PCG 690 Oxford Street Chula Vista, CA 91911 (619) 270-4100	YMCA Stage Two 3601 Arey Drive San Diego, CA 92154 Phone Number: (619) 474-4707
N. Coastal	Equus-YMCA Stage One 3708 Ocean Ranch Boulevard Oceanside, CA 92056 (619) 521-3055, Ext 2480	CDA 5473 Kearny Villa Road, Suite 350 San Diego, CA 92123 (619) 427-4411, Ext 1700
N. Inland	Equus-YMCA Stage One 613 W. Valley Parkway, Suite 200 Escondido, CA 92025 (619) 521-3055, Ext 2466	CDA 5473 Kearny Villa Road, Suite 350 San Diego, CA 92123 (858) 836-8065

Non-CalWORKs Parents/Caretaker Relatives
CalWORKs Assistance Units who do not include at least one CalWORKs or Former CalWORKs parent/caretaker relative who has received aid within the last 24 months, are not eligible for CalWORKs Stage One Child Care.

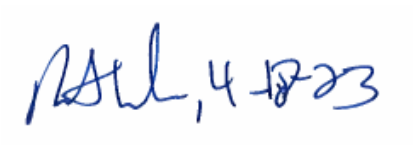
The Non-CalWORKs parent/caretaker relatives who have a child care need, may be referred to the Centralized Eligibility List (CEL) at 1(800)-521-0560 or https://carewait2-family.carecloud.io/SDCEL .

Procedure:
10-010.A1 Child Care Request Process
10-010.A2 Form CCP7
10-010.A3 Form CCP8
10-010.A4Transitioning Child Care Cases to Stage Two

References:
MPP 47-101, 47-301; CCR, Title 5, Chapter 19

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by April 30, 2026.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self Sufficiency Services